🎭 Art & Culture — Master File · SSC CGL

> **The single consolidated Art & Culture resource** — Classical Dances, Music, Architecture, Painting, Festivals & UNESCO heritage, with PYQ question-types, curated & new questions. Per the PYQ Blueprint.

> ℹ️ Important Days, International Organizations & Books/Authors (formerly clubbed here) now live in the **Current Affairs Special master**.

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1. How SSC Asks Art & Culture (PYQ Types)

PYQs are the blueprint. The recurring shapes:

Type	Example stem	Prep
Dance → state	"Kathakali belongs to —"	Dance tables (§2–3)
Instrument → exponent	"Sitar is associated with —"	Music (§4)
Monument → builder/style	"Who built the Taj Mahal?"	Architecture (§5)
Festival → state	"Onam is celebrated in —"	Festivals (§7)
Painting/UNESCO	"How many World Heritage Sites?"	§6, §8

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2. Classical Dances

8 classical dances (recognised by the Sangeet Natak Akademi):

Dance	State
Bharatanatyam	Tamil Nadu (oldest)
Kathak	Uttar Pradesh / North India
Kathakali	Kerala (elaborate make-up & masks)
Mohiniyattam	Kerala (solo, by women)
Kuchipudi	Andhra Pradesh
Odissi	Odisha
Manipuri	Manipur
Sattriya	Assam (by saint Sankardev)

3. Folk Dances

Folk dance	State
Bhangra / Giddha	Punjab
Garba / Dandiya	Gujarat
Bihu	Assam
Lavani	Maharashtra
Ghoomar / Kalbelia	Rajasthan
Chhau	Jharkhand / Odisha / WB
Yakshagana	Karnataka

4. Music (Classical & Instruments)

- **Two systems: Hindustani** (North) & **Carnatic** (South). Purandara Dasa = "Father of Carnatic music".
- **Instrument → exponent (classic):** Sitar → **Ravi Shankar** · Sarod → Amjad Ali Khan · Santoor → Shivkumar Sharma · Flute → Hariprasad Chaurasia · Tabla → Zakir Hussain · Shehnai → **Bismillah Khan** · Violin → L. Subramaniam · Mandolin → U. Srinivas.
- **Gharanas** (Hindustani vocal): Gwalior (oldest), Kirana, Jaipur, Agra, Patiala.

5. Architecture

- **Ancient:** Stupas (Sanchi — Ashoka), rock-cut caves (**Ajanta & Ellora**, Maharashtra; Ajanta = Buddhist paintings), Sun Temple **Konark** (Odisha), Khajuraho (MP, Chandelas), Brihadeeswarar (Thanjavur, Cholas).
- **Indo-Islamic:** Qutub Minar (Delhi — Aibak/Iltutmish), Taj Mahal (**Shah Jahan**), Red Fort & Jama Masjid (Shah Jahan), Fatehpur Sikri & Buland Darwaza (Akbar), Charminar (Hyderabad — Qutb Shahi), Gol Gumbaz (Bijapur).
- **Temple styles: Nagara** (North), **Dravida** (South), **Vesara** (Deccan hybrid).
- **Colonial:** India Gate, Gateway of India (Mumbai), Victoria Memorial (Kolkata).

6. Painting

- **Schools:** Mughal miniature, **Rajput/Rajasthani**, Pahari (Kangra), Madhubani (Bihar), Warli (Maharashtra), Tanjore (gold-leaf), Kalamkari (AP).
- **Raja Ravi Varma** — pioneer of modern Indian painting; "Yashoda and Krishna" is the costliest auctioned Indian artwork (₹167.2 cr, 2026).
- Ajanta caves — finest ancient Buddhist murals.

7. Festivals

Festival	State
Onam, Vishu, Thrissur Pooram	Kerala
Pongal	Tamil Nadu
Bihu	Assam
Baisakhi / Lohri	Punjab
Hornbill Festival	Nagaland
Hemis Festival	Ladakh
Chhath Puja	Bihar
Rann Utsav	Gujarat
Konark Dance Festival	Odisha
Pushkar Fair	Rajasthan

8. UNESCO Heritage (current — verify before exam)

- **India's UNESCO World Heritage Sites: 44** (36 cultural, 7 natural, 1 mixed). Recent: Maratha Military Landscapes, Moidams of Assam.
- **Deepavali** added to the UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage list (India's 16th element, Dec 2025).

9. Curated PYQ-Pattern Questions

Q1. Bharatanatyam belongs to — (a) Kerala (b) **Tamil Nadu** (c) Odisha (d) Manipur

Q2. Kathakali is associated with — (a) AP (b) TN (c) **Kerala** (d) Assam

Q3. Sattriya originated in — (a) **Assam** (b) Odisha (c) Manipur (d) Bengal

Q4. Onam is celebrated mainly in — (a) TN (b) **Kerala** (c) Karnataka (d) AP

Q5. The shehnai maestro was — (a) Ravi Shankar (b) **Bismillah Khan** (c) Zakir Hussain (d) Amjad Ali Khan

Q6. Sitar is associated with — (a) **Ravi Shankar** (b) Bismillah Khan (c) Hariprasad Chaurasia (d) Shivkumar Sharma

Q7. The Sun Temple is located at — (a) Khajuraho (b) **Konark** (c) Hampi (d) Thanjavur

Q8. Ajanta & Ellora caves are in — (a) MP (b) **Maharashtra** (c) Karnataka (d) Gujarat

Q9. North Indian temple architecture style is — (a) Dravida (b) **Nagara** (c) Vesara (d) Gothic

Q10. The Hornbill Festival is celebrated in — (a) Manipur (b) **Nagaland** (c) Mizoram (d) Assam

Q11. Lavani is a folk dance of — (a) Gujarat (b) **Maharashtra** (c) Punjab (d) Rajasthan

Q12. Madhubani painting originates from — (a) **Bihar** (b) Bengal (c) Odisha (d) MP

Q13. Charminar was built by the — (a) Mughals (b) Cholas (c) **Qutb Shahi** dynasty (d) Marathas

Q14. "Father of Carnatic music" — (a) Tyagaraja (b) **Purandara Dasa** (c) Tansen (d) Swati Tirunal

Q15. Garba is the folk dance of — (a) **Gujarat** (b) Rajasthan (c) Punjab (d) Haryana

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10. Freshly-Created Practice Questions

New questions in the SSC pattern; answer key at the end.

N1. Which classical dance is performed only by women in a graceful solo form in Kerala?

(a) Kathakali (b) Mohiniyattam (c) Kuchipudi (d) Odissi

N2. The Brihadeeswarar Temple at Thanjavur was built by the —

(a) Cholas (b) Pallavas (c) Chalukyas (d) Chandelas

N3. The tabla maestro among the following is —

(a) L. Subramaniam (b) Zakir Hussain (c) Amjad Ali Khan (d) U. Srinivas

N4. Warli painting is associated with which state?

(a) Bihar (b) Maharashtra (c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Odisha

N5. Which festival was added to UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list in Dec 2025?

(a) Holi (b) Deepavali (c) Onam (d) Pongal

N6. Kuchipudi is the classical dance of —

(a) Tamil Nadu (b) Andhra Pradesh (c) Kerala (d) Karnataka

N7. The Dravida style of temple architecture is predominant in —

(a) North India (b) South India (c) the Deccan (d) the Himalayas

N8. Gol Gumbaz is located in —

(a) Hyderabad (b) Bijapur (c) Agra (d) Delhi

N9. Kalbelia and Ghoomar are folk dances of —

(a) Gujarat (b) Punjab (c) Rajasthan (d) Haryana

N10. Yakshagana is a folk theatre form of —

(a) Kerala (b) Karnataka (c) Tamil Nadu (d) Telangana

Answer Key (Section 10):

N1-(b) Mohiniyattam · N2-(a) Cholas · N3-(b) Zakir Hussain · N4-(b) Maharashtra · N5-(b) Deepavali · N6-(b) Andhra Pradesh · N7-(b) South India · N8-(b) Bijapur · N9-(c) Rajasthan · N10-(b) Karnataka

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11. Rapid Revision Sheet

- 8 classical dances: Bharatanatyam (TN) · Kathak (UP) · Kathakali & Mohiniyattam (Kerala) · Kuchipudi (AP) · Odissi (Odisha) · Manipuri (Manipur) · Sattriya (Assam)
- Folk: Bhangra (Punjab) · Garba (Gujarat) · Bihu (Assam) · Lavani (Maharashtra) · Ghoomar/Kalbelia (Rajasthan) · Yakshagana (Karnataka)
- Music: Sitar → Ravi Shankar · Shehnai → Bismillah Khan · Tabla → Zakir Hussain · Flute → Hariprasad Chaurasia · Carnatic father → Purandara Dasa
- Architecture: Konark Sun Temple · Ajanta/Ellora (Maharashtra) · Nagara (N) / Dravida (S) / Vesara (Deccan) · Charminar (Qutb Shahi)
- Painting: Madhubani (Bihar) · Warli (Maharashtra) · Tanjore (gold) · Raja Ravi Varma
- Festivals: Onam (Kerala) · Pongal (TN) · Hornbill (Nagaland) · Rann Utsav (Gujarat) · Chhath (Bihar)
- UNESCO: 44 World Heritage Sites · Deepavali on ICH list (2025)

> ⚠ Current UNESCO/CA figures change — verify before exam. Back to Static GK Index · PYQ Blueprint.